



INTRODUCTION

COMPLETE RULES - APRIL 2018 UPDATE

Welcome to the world of Rage, where the werewolves (also known as Garou) are fighting a losing battle against the forces of corruption (the Wyrms). These tribal warriors are ferocious in battle, but there are many battles to fight, and the Garou's forces also turn on each other in frustration. It is a time of desperation, a time of despair ... and a time for great heroes to do great deeds! The battle howl has sounded! When Will You Rage?

OVERVIEW

Rage was first produced as a [Collectible Card Game](#) (CCG) in 1995, based on the first edition of the [Werewolf: the Apocalypse](#) roleplaying game. This version of **Rage** is known as Rage: Apocalypse. Five sets of cards were printed by White Wolf. Since then, fan sets have been produced with permission of White Wolf, available as printable PDFs and online.

Each player has a pack which is trying to prove that it is better than the other packs. The pack achieves this by earning Victory Points (VP). The main method of acquiring VP is by killing prey or members of other packs, but packs can also gain VP from Quests, calling and winning votes and by other means. As well as the Characters they start with, players have their combat deck (used to kill creatures - or prevent death) and their sept deck (which contains resources, game altering cards and alternate methods of getting VP). Packs can serve either Gaia or Wyrms. Both allegiances play using the same rules.

RULES VERSIONS

We have updated the rules at various points over the years. To help players focus on rules which may have changed, we have highlighted newer sections according to when they were updated.

W20th Junta 2018 --- Call of the Sea 2014 --- Revised 2007 --- Ahadi 2006 --- New England 2001-5 --- Early rulings (pre 2000)

CHAPTER 1: AREAS OF PLAY

1.1 PACK HOME GROUND

The Pack Home Ground is where your pack spends most of its time. It includes all members of your pack, their pack resources and their Pack Totem. All pack members within the Home Ground are available for pack actions, and can use pack resources and the pack totem. All of a player's decks, discard piles and their Victory Pile are considered to be in the Pack Home Ground. Decks are face down, discard piles are face up.

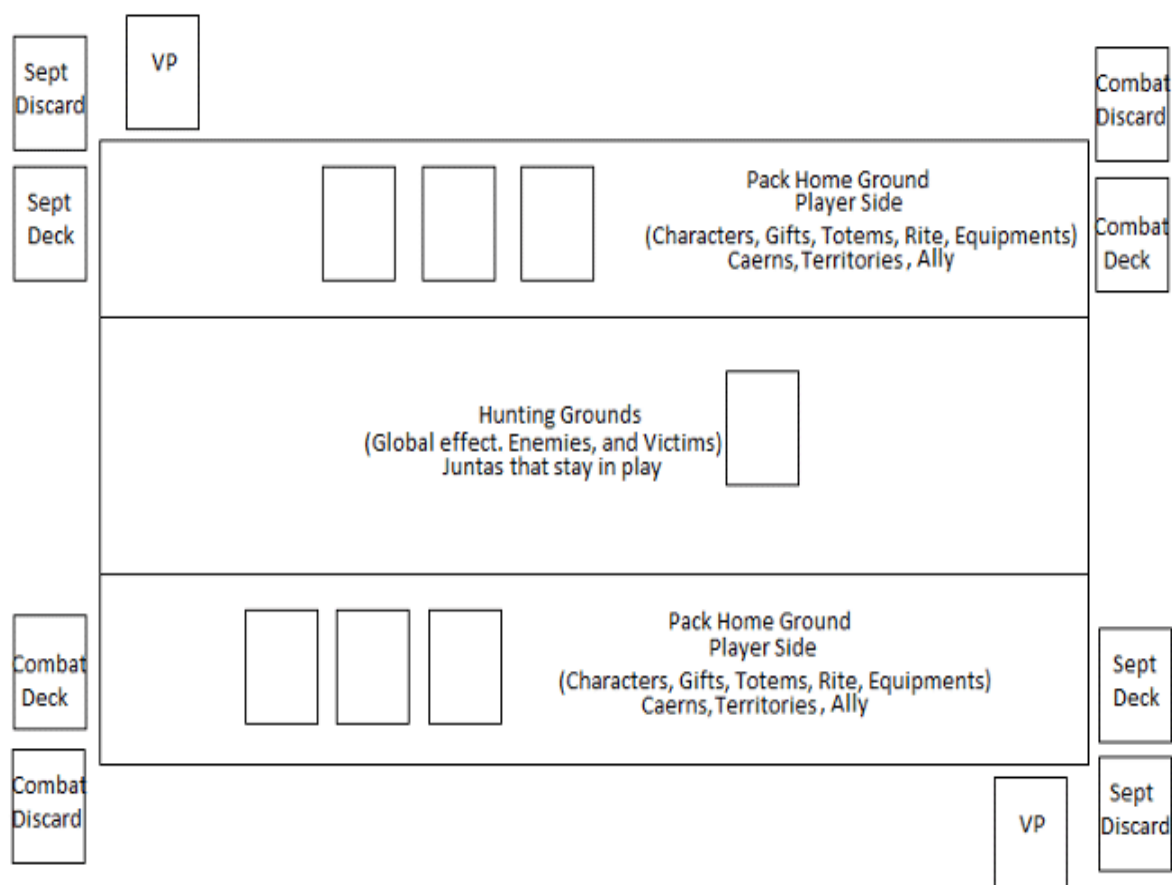
1.2 HUNTING GROUNDS

The Hunting Grounds is the area in the center of the playing field between all of the players' packs. Enemies and Victims residing in the Hunting Grounds are waiting for Characters to goad them into battle. **Alphas are not considered to be in the Hunting Grounds, nor do they enter the Hunting Grounds when fighting other opponents.**

Characters temporarily in the Hunting Grounds are away from their pack but are still controlled by the same player - only that player can use the Character and play cards for it. The Character may still equip, use Rites or Gifts and attempt Quests; they cannot play, Allies, Pack Totems and pack resources; and they cannot be part of pack actions with the rest of their pack. Characters in the Hunting Grounds can be attacked by Alphas as their Alpha action.

1.3 THE UMBRA

The Umbra is the spirit world, a dreamlike reflection of the physical world that runs parallel to it. Packs may use the Umbra for a specific purpose, as an alternate fighting ground or to try and elude their foes. A section of the Hunting Grounds and each player's Pack Home Ground should be designated as an Umbral zone where creatures in the Umbra are placed. Alternatively mark creatures



in the Umbra with a token of some sort.

The barrier between the Umbra and the physical world is known as the Gauntlet and is difficult to breach. Most effects cannot work across the Gauntlet (that is, between the physical world and the Umbra, and vice versa). See Rules for the Umbra

1.4 VICTORY PILE

A player's Victory Pile is the record of the earned renown of the pack. Any kills the pack makes in combat are placed in their Victory Pile. Card abilities may place other cards in a player's Victory Pile. Creatures placed face up in your Victory Pile are always worth their printed Renown in VP, unless a card changes the amount of VP awarded. Cards are normally placed in the Victory Pile face up. Face down cards in a Victory Pile are always worth 1 VP. Turn cards that are worth zero VP sideways in your pile. See VP complications

Any player may inspect the contents of a player's Victory Pile at any time. Unique cards in a Victory Pile do not prevent a copy of that card from being played. The contents of the Victory Pile can only be targetted or affected by cards that specifically target it.

1.5 OUT OF PLAY

Certain abilities will temporarily place a creature out of play (also referred to as removing it from the game). The card which removed the creature will specify the duration. Cards that are Out of Play are not considered to be in either the Umbra or the Physical World, but return to the world they came from when they return to play.

While out of play, creatures cannot be targeted by any card or ability, cannot take any actions, cannot use their special abilities and cannot enter combat. Such creatures can still regenerate, and Characters and Allies are still considered to be part of their pack. Any cards attached to an out-of-play creature (e.g. equipment) are also out of play.

Any other card that is placed temporarily out of play is not affected by anything. The abilities on any out-of-play cards cannot affect the game. Cards that are out of play are still checked for uniqueness and similar restrictions - you cannot play a copy of a Unique Fetish that is currently out of play.

1.6 REMOVED FROM THE GAME

A card permanently removed from the game, including Characters that died outside combat, (see Death) has no effect on the game again. It is not considered for Global Effects, Uniqueness (or similar restrictions). Such cards are face up.

CHAPTER 2: THE BASIC GAME

2.1 PREPARING TO PLAY

2.1.01 DECIDE RENOWN LEVEL

At the beginning of the game, all of the players decide the Renown level that they wish to play. The Renown of all of the Characters in a single pack must be less than or equal to the Renown level of the game. Also, the Renown level dictates how many victory points are required to win the game. Players wanting a shorter game should choose a low Renown level; players wanting a longer and more involved game should choose a higher Renown level.

The standard Renown level of the game is 20.

2.1.2 SEPARATE YOUR DECK

Cards should be separated according to their types: combat, sept and Character. A player must have a minimum of 20 combat cards (maximum 2 of each card) and 30 sept cards (maximum 3 of each card), but there is no maximum deck size. Shuffle the sept deck, then shuffle the combat deck. A player may have any number of Characters as long as their Renown total does not exceed the Renown level of the game.

Characters should be set out breed form up (their “normal” form - i.e. not crinos or battle form; some Characters only have one form and are the same on both sides of the card). More than one player can have the same Character in their deck, but each player can only have one copy of a Character. Exception: you may have up to 5 copies of the same Multiple character in your deck.

Non-Character cards that begin in play must come from your sept deck and, once they are put in play, your sept deck must still contain the minimum number of cards. These cards are counted towards the maximum number of copies of a single card you can have in your deck. EXAMPLE: If your character starts with a Klaive, once it is removed from your deck, the sept deck must still contain the minimum AND it can only have 2 more Klaives.

2.1.3 HAND SIZES

The default hand size for both sept hands and combat hands is 5 cards. If a player's sept hand size is increased or decreased for any reason (e.g. Old Storm Chaser), when their player (re)draws their sept hand they draw to the adjusted sept hand size instead. Similarly with an altered combat hand size.

2.1.4 TURN SEQUENCE

Rage is played by all players simultaneously. Everyone shares all of the Phases and is considered to be acting at the same time. The only exception to this rule is the Combat phase, in which Alphas act in descending order of Renown.

The phases are (in order):

1. Redraw phase
2. Regeneration phase
3. Resource phase
4. Umbra phase
5. Moot phase
6. Combat phase

Thus, all players redraw at the same time, go through the regeneration phase at the same time, etc. Effects which state they automatically end at beginning of turn or end of turn occur outside the normal phases, so will happen even if a phase is skipped by a card effect.

2.2 PHASES IN DETAIL

This section describes the contents of the turn phases. While it summarises how cards are played within the phases, more detail on cards use can be found in the following chapters. Two terms, *Closed play* and *Open play*, are described in *Timing*. In brief, during closed play you can mostly only take actions listed in this section. In open play, you can play anything else that makes sense.

2.2.2. REDRAW PHASE

Closed Play. In the first Redraw phase of the game, all players draw their first sept hand (equal to their sept hand size). They also draw their first combat hand (equal to their combat hand size). No actions can be taken until all players have drawn these cards.

Closed Play. During each following Redraw phase, players may discard any cards from their sept hand that they wish to (up to their whole hand). **THEN** draw enough cards to fill their hand to their sept hand size. If a player's sept deck is empty, he does not draw any more cards but is otherwise unaffected.

Open Play. The rest of the phase is Open Play.

2.1.2 REGENERATION PHASE

Closed Play. Characters are hardy. At the beginning of the Regeneration phase, all Characters and regenerating Allies and Prey return the single non-aggravated, lowest damage card attached to them (if any) to the original owner's appropriate discard pile. Where there is a tie for lowest damage, the creature's controller (or prey's owner) decides which is discarded. No action can be taken or card played during this phase until all regeneration is completed.

Aggravated damage cannot be regenerated like this. See section on Healing Damage. If your lowest damage card is aggravated, you would regenerate your next lowest damage card instead.

Allies, Enemies and Victims do not, as a rule, regenerate. Most that do are marked with the note (*regenerates*) at the bottom of their statistics, but see Creature Classes for further clarification.

Open Play. The rest of the phase is Open Play.

2.2.3 RESOURCE PHASE

Closed Play. At the beginning of this phase, players may play creatures (Allies, Enemies and Victims) and resources (Caerns, Equipment, Realms and Territories). Prey (Enemies and Victims) and Battlefields are played to the Hunting Grounds. Equipment is played on (and attaches to) a Character or Ally that meets the requirements. Other resources are pack resources and are played to the Pack Home Grounds.

All resources played during Closed Play are considered to be played simultaneously, and their effects do not take place until Closed Play is finished. If any Unique card is played by more than one player during Closed Play, the person who may keep it is randomly determined (all extra copies are returned to their player's sept hand).

Open Play. The rest of the round is Open Play. Players can still play creatures and resources, but they are not considered to be played simultaneously. Use Open Play timing instead. Equipment may also be traded to another Character or Ally that meets the requirements during this phase, although only once per item (see Equipment)

2.2. 4 UMBRA PHASE

Closed Play. At the beginning of the Umbra phase, Characters may use a Caern in their pack to step sideways (i.e. to move into or out of the Umbra).

A creature can step sideways using the Caern in its pack if:

- it is a Character
- its Creature Class can step sideways
- AND its gnosis is equal to or greater than the Gauntlet of the Caern.

All creatures stepping sideways this way enter or leave the Umbra simultaneously, and a Character cannot use the Caern twice in the same Umbra phase to both enter and leave the Umbra. The Character can use other means of moving into or out of the Umbra.

Sidebar: Older timings

Many early cards don't fit these timing rules. Some have clarifications in the [errata]. Others fit standard patterns.

- Any card that says "play at the beginning of X phase" or "start of X phase" are played during Closed Play of that phase, even if it would normally be considered an offensive action. These cards are played during Closed Play but resolve after actions prescribed by the rules in this section.
- Cards that say they are played at the start of turn or beginning of turn are played during Redraw (Open Play).
- Cards which refer to the Equip/Ally phase are played during Resource.

Open Play. The rest of the phase is Open Play.

2.2.5 MOOT PHASE

Closed Play: no specific actions.

The rest of the phase is Open Play

Characters may call (play) Moots or Board Meetings at the beginning of the Moot phase.

Characters have a number of votes equal to their Renown and can use those votes in every Junta they are eligible to vote in. Juntas are voted on in order of Renown and, if they pass, resolve immediately. See Juntas for detailed timing.

2.2.6 COMBAT PHASE

Closed Play. At the beginning of the Combat phase, players may discard any cards from their combat hand that they wish to (up to their whole hand) and then draw enough cards to fill their hands to their combat hand size. If a player runs out of combat cards, simply reshuffle the discarded ones and proceed as normal.

Open Play. Each player then selects a Character or Ally from their pack to be their alpha, the pack member who will represent its pack during the current Combat phase (players **must** pick an alpha if possible). The player then pushes the alpha to the forefront of the pack. If, during the course of the Combat phase, that alpha is killed or otherwise lost, the player may not select another until the next Combat phase. A player may select a different alpha every combat phase, or use the same one repeatedly.

Werewolves - in fact most of Gaia's shapeshifters - defer to their elders, while the Wyrms' minions cower before those more powerful than them. As such, the alpha with the highest Renown takes his alpha action first (ties are decided randomly as soon as all alphas have been selected). Once the first alpha has finished their alpha action, the alpha with the next highest Renown takes his action, and so on.

As its alpha action, an alpha may do one of the following:

- Attack any other alpha in play.
- Attack any Enemy or Victim in the Hunting Grounds.
- Attack a Spirit in the Hunting Grounds AND in the umbra to bind it.
- Issue a challenge to a non-alpha pack member in play. That pack member may refuse at his option.
- Engage a Battlefield
- Attack another player's Territory
- Use a card or special ability that says it is done as an Alpha action
- Pass and do nothing.

See Combat for details of how attacks work.

2.3 WINNING THE GAME

At the end of any Combat phase, if a single player has accumulated Victory Points (VP) equal to or exceeding the Renown level of the game, he has won. If two or more players have equal to or greater than the Renown level, the player with the most VP wins. In the event of a tie, the game continues for another turn (and more, until there is a clear winner). Players that are entirely out of sept cards may still win the game if they have enough VP.

A player that has lost all of their Characters is out of the game. All cards in their Pack Home Grounds, other than their combat deck and discards, are immediately removed from play; any cards he has in play outside of his Pack Home Grounds remain in play. The player may no longer play any sept cards. They may play combat cards for Prey in the Hunting Grounds. If the player has gained enough points to win on the turn he is taken out, he still wins, as his pack's heroic actions are still remembered in the tales of the Garou. A player with no pack may not be targeted by cards that affect packs, Victory Piles, etc.

Sidebar: Quick combat summary

For full details see Combat

- Announce target of attack
- Players may play Open Play cards and use special abilities
- There follow a series of combat rounds:

1. Play-card step
2. Targeting step
3. Reveal step
4. Establish- bluff step
5. Resolution step
6. Withdrawal step
7. Between-rounds step

Combat ends when the attacker withdraws, a round passes in which no combat cards are played or a card ability ends it.